

SIBIN BLESSEN

Technical Lead & Senior Software Engineer | Java, Spring Boot, Kafka & Cloud-Native Systems

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SUMMARY

Technical Lead and hands-on backend engineer with 8 years of experience building scalable, maintainable systems. Currently combines day-to-day development with guiding technical strategy across ~10 engineering teams, helping them design resilient solutions, write clean code and ship with confidence. Core stack is Java, Spring Boot and Apache Kafka on Kubernetes, with experience across Python, Go, JavaScript and modern frontend frameworks. Cares as much about the product and user experience as about code quality, and treats languages as tools: what matters is understanding the real problem, business or technical, and shaping the right solution. Actively brings AI into engineering work, from LLM-assisted testing and documentation to building a RAG-based knowledge system.

CORE SKILLS

Backend: Java, Spring Boot, Quarkus, microservices, REST API design (OpenAPI), JPA / Hibernate, Maven

Messaging & Data: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, SQL, asynchronous / event-driven processing, caching

Cloud & DevOps: Microsoft Azure (AKS), AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD (GitLab CI/CD, GitHub), build and release automation, Git

Observability & Quality: Splunk, Grafana, logging and monitoring, JUnit, automated testing, code reviews, clean code, SOLID, domain-driven design

AI: LLM integration (OpenAI API), retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), semantic / vector search, AI-assisted development

Also Worked With: Python, Go, C, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Angular, Vue.js, Android

Leadership: Technical direction, mentoring, stakeholder management, requirements gathering, Agile delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead & Senior Software Engineer

05/2022 – Present

Tata Consultancy Services | Copenhagen, Denmark

- Design, build and ship backend services in Java, Spring Boot and Apache Kafka on Kubernetes, taking features from design through development, testing and production.
- Guide technical strategy across ~10 engineering teams (2–6 engineers each) and lead a core team of 6 developers, supporting solution design, architecture decisions and code quality.
- Introduced asynchronous event streaming with Kafka for selected workflows where it fit the problem, improving response times while keeping the rest of the system simple and maintainable.
- Implemented caching and lazy loading to reduce database query load and infrastructure usage.
- Mentor developers and run code reviews that teach; established shared testing standards, developer guides and operational runbooks.
- Work with product owners and business stakeholders to align DevOps initiatives and delivery plans with business priorities.
- Brought LLMs into the engineering workflow for code analysis, test generation and documentation, and shared these practices across teams; run training sessions on new tools and frameworks.

Java Developer

08/2021 – 04/2022

Tata Consultancy Services | Kochi, India

- Designed and built scalable backend services for an insurance claims chatbot, improving the customer claims experience.
- Built cloud-native, containerized Java services on Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS).
- Automated build and release pipelines (CI/CD), substantially reducing manual deployment effort.
- Implemented monitoring and logging with Splunk, enabling faster issue detection and incident response.
- Refactored non-critical synchronous processes into scheduled batch jobs, reducing peak-time load.

Full Stack Developer & Interim Team Lead

12/2018 – 07/2021

Tata Consultancy Services | Kochi, India

- Led a team of 8 developers using Agile practices, building a culture of open communication, peer learning and knowledge sharing.
- Designed and maintained APIs for system integration and data-processing workflows.
- Worked directly with customers to gather requirements and align technical solutions with business needs.
- Optimized the existing codebase to cut load times and improve user experience; built the data layer with JPA.
- Introduced unit testing with JUnit to strengthen code quality and stability.
- Developed and maintained an Android application and upskilled in frontend frameworks and cloud tooling to fill team capability gaps.

Full Stack & Product Engineer (Freelance)

AdventureTripr | Remote

- Built and shipped end-to-end product features across frontend and backend.
- Took on a product engineering role as the engagement grew, shaping feature scope and product decisions alongside development.

SELECTED PROJECT

AI Knowledge System (RAG) | *Go, PostgreSQL vector search (Supabase), OpenAI API*

- Built a system that ingests personal documents, retrieves relevant context through semantic search and uses LLMs to generate grounded answers.
- Implemented the backend APIs in Go, with embeddings stored and queried in a PostgreSQL vector database on Supabase, and answer generation through the OpenAI API.
- Also builds side projects in Python, Go and JavaScript to explore new tools and ideas.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Information Technology

2014 - 2018

Adi Shankara Institute of Engineering and Technology, Kochi, India

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microservices Architecture and Event-Driven Systems (TCS internal certification)
- Advanced Java and Spring Boot Development (TCS internal certification)
- Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) and Best Practices (TCS internal certification)